

Quantitative Impact Evaluation of Política De Paz Total in Colombia

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1 Introduction

Violence in Colombia remains geographically uneven, organizationally fragmented, and historically persistent. Although the 2016 peace agreement with the FARC-EP marked a turning point in the country’s recent history, it did not produce a uniform transition to peace across the national territory. As Johnson et al. note, the agreement “marked a milestone in the country’s recent history” because it demobilized the most important armed group that represented the greatest threat to state control,” allowing “multiple regions of the country to experience peace after decades of absence” (Johnson et al., 2025, p. 7, author’s translation). Yet they also stress that, after the demobilization of the FARC, “some regions repeated cycles of violence” as other armed and criminal groups expanded their zones of control and dissident FARC factions emerged (Johnson et al., 2025, p. 7, author’s translation).

In this sense, the post-2016 period should be understood less as a linear transition from war to peace than as a reconfiguration of armed order across territories with different institutional, political, and criminal structures. This interpretation is consistent with Pécaut’s long-run reading of the Colombian conflict, which emphasizes the exceptional continuity of armed organization and notes that the FARC maintained both “longevity” and “cohesion” even as Colombia underwent profound social and political transformations (Pécaut, 2008, pp. 23-24).

Under this context, Petro’s government inherited a country marked by rising humanitarian impacts, including the highest recent levels of forced displacement and confinement, continued

killings of social leaders, and an increase in homicide after a long period of decline at the national level (FIP, 2023, p. 5, author’s translation). Colombia’s current violent landscape is thus not only severe, but also regionally differentiated and shaped by multiple armed actors whose logics of control vary across territory. It was in this context that the government of Gustavo Petro adopted the Política de Paz Total (PPT).

The policy sought to negotiate simultaneously with a broad range of actors, including insurgent organizations and criminal groups, under an ambitious and territorially expansive peace agenda. Johnson et al. describe this new approach as one that “promotes simultaneous negotiations with criminal organizations and political armed groups in order to establish a complete peace” (Johnson et al., 2025, p. 7, author’s translation). Johnson’s article is consistent with other literature and news portals. From CORE to the GITOC, sources consistently report either policy failure or mixed results, with an increase in violence across the entire country (Ambos, 2026; Preciado, 2026). Nonetheless, these assessments are merely qualitative; assessing people’s perspectives, and rely on descriptive statistics that might be missing a more complex picture.

Therefore, this thesis aims to measure the impact of the policy in the violent structure of the conflict using quantitative methods, to fill this literature gap. The aim is to review the causal mechanism, and if there is quantitative evidence to back up the qualitative research results or prove the opposite. With this goal in mind, violence is not understood simply as an episodic outcome of armed conflict, but as a mechanism through which armed groups govern territory, discipline populations, and manage competition. Johnson et al. (2025) state that “violence is the central factor for understanding how armed actors control and govern territories and local societies” (p.23, author’s translation).

2 Research Design

2.1 Research Question

Within Buenaventura, Arauca, and Tumaco where peace negotiations were initiated under Petro’s ‘Total Peace’ policy (2022-2026), what is the association between the timing of those negotiations and the monthly incidence of conflict-related events (homicide, extortion, terrorism, civilian targeting, and political violence)?

Alternative Hypothesis (H1): The initiation of peace negotiations is associated with a statistically significant change in the monthly frequency of specific conflict-related crimes.

Null Hypothesis (H0): The initiation of formal peace talks in a municipality has no statistically significant association with the monthly frequency of specific conflict-related events.

Alternative Hypothesis 2 (H2): The initiation of peace negotiations is associated with a statistically significant positive change in frequency of specific conflict-related crimes.

2.2 Methodology and Variables

Methodologically, the study uses panel data and estimates two-way fixed-effects models. Two-way fixed models are a preferred tool as they enable us to address confounding biases that are unobservable but are common to all observed units (Dayal and Murugesan, 2023). In this case, the geographical level fixed effects account for unobserved time-invariant heterogeneity, while time fixed effects absorb time-varying (Dayal and Murugesan, 2023). Applied to this study, territorial-case fixed effects absorb time-invariant characteristics of each case, including geography, long-run armed-group presence, and local institutional structure, while month fixed effects absorb shocks common to all cases, such as macro-political changes, seasonality, and countrywide security dynamics. The identifying logic is therefore within-case overtime comparison: the model tests whether violence changes once peace talks begin in a given case, net of permanent differences across territories and common shocks affecting all territories in the same month.

The panel-data is composed of Colombia’s violent trends across three subnational cases: Buenaventura, Arauca, and Tumaco, measured as the monthly count of violent events. This choice treats event counts as an indicator of the frequency with which local populations are exposed to coercive practices. This is especially important in settings where peace talks may reduce one form of violence while displacing it into another. For that reason, the analysis uses an aggregate outcome and a disaggregated.

The disaggregated outcome is composed of 5 variables. Three of them, **homicides**, **terrorism**, and **extortion** come from police reports aggregated to the monthly level. Two additional variables come from ACLED and are likewise converted to monthly counts. **civilian_targeting** measures the monthly count of reported civilian targeting events. According to the ACLED dataset definition, civilian targeting includes violence against civilians events and explosions/remote violence events

in which civilians were directly targeted. `political_violence` measures the monthly count of reported political violence events. In ACLED’s definition, political violence includes battles, violence against civilians, explosions/remote violence, and the mob violence sub-event type within riots. The set of variables are used as monthly counts of observed events rather than fatalities, and both are harmonized to the same case-month structure. Whereas, the aggregated variable is just the addition of these five components.

The mechanism of interest is whether the beginning of negotiations alters the strategic incentives of armed actors and is therefore associated with changes in the level of observed violence. As Johnson et al. argue, “timing and sequencing are key factors in the development of dialogue processes” (Johnson et al., 2025, p. 6, author’s translation), and the implementation of *Paz Total* opened “a window of opportunity for the emergence, resurgence, or reconfiguration of rebel or criminal forms of governance” (Johnson et al., 2025, p. 21, author’s translation). In the data, this mechanism is expressed as a change in monthly violent trends after the onset of peace talks relative to the pre-treatment period.

Violence is a mechanism of control. It includes coercive practices aimed at enforcing rules, punishing disobedience, and shaping local orders. This logic is consistent with Arjona’s argument that “when armed groups control a territory and pursue long-term goals, they prefer to create rebelocracies” (Arjona, 2016, pp. 100-101), rebelocracies, are governments of armed groups whose foundations of govern come from terror and violent punishment. This is also consistent with Masullo’s claim that civilian agency “can affect the level of violence that armed groups inflict on civilians (...), the distribution of territorial control and the establishment of rebel governance” (Masullo, 2020, pp. 2-3). The selected variables are, therefore, observable expressions of how armed actors compete, regulate, and govern.

The main explanatory variable is `treatment`, a binary indicator coded as 1 during the months in which peace talks or formal negotiation processes were active in a given territorial case, and 0 otherwise. The treatment is not defined as a final agreement, a ceasefire outcome, or a successful demobilization, but rather as the period during which negotiations were underway under the framework of *Política de Paz Total*, or based on the armed group agreeing to begin the negotiations and had started reducing military actions even if the table hadn’t officially begun.

The coding of treatment periods relies primarily on Johnson et al. (2025), and news portals.

In Arauca, the treatment begins in August 2022, when negotiations with the ELN resumed under the Petro administration (Johnson et al., 2025, p. 35), and is coded as ending in September 2024, when the process was suspended following the ELN attack on a military base in Arauca (*El Colombiano*, 2024). In Tumaco, the treatment begins in June 2024, when formal talks with the Segunda Marquetalia began and included the operational units in Tumaco (Johnson et al., 2025, p. 43). The treatment remains active through the end of the observed period because subsequent public reporting indicates continued dialogue with successor structures linked to that process (*El País*, 2025; *La Silla Vacía*, 2025). In Buenaventura, the treatment begins in September 2022, following the initiation of the preliminary negotiation phase between Los Shottas and Los Espartanos under the broader *Paz Total* framework (Johnson et al., 2025, pp. 29–30).

A central extension of the baseline design is the inclusion of time-varying control for armed-group dispute. The variable Clash is coded as a binary indicator equal to 1 in months in which a territorial case is experiencing active inter-group conflict and 0 otherwise. This control is included because changes in violence may reflect not only negotiation dynamics but also shifts in territorial confrontation among armed organizations. In substantive terms, control is especially important for Arauca, where violence rises in the context of an intensifying dispute beginning in January 2022 (Celis, 2026), and for Buenaventura, where the intensity of confrontation changes across periods of conflict and truce (SAGA UNODC, 2024; Reynoso, 2025; RTVC, 2025). Tumaco is coded as exposed to persistent inter-group conflict throughout the observed period. Including this variable helps separate the association between peace talks and violence from the association between violence and active armed dispute.

The study adopts a case-based territorial panel rather than a nationally pooled design because the relevant variation is local and because the territorial scale of armed governance differs across cases. This is based on two facts, one is the policy design itself, the Total Peace Policy “focuses on how local governance dynamics influence the implementation of Total Peace and highlights how they differ according to the local conditions of each region” (Johnson et al., 2025, p. 7, author’s translation). And second, as Colombia cannot be studied as a homogeneous region. The country is composed by several regions, that are built as oppositions of the "center". These, are a complex puzzle that has unique ways of governance, crime and even culture (Serge, 2006).

Accordingly, the unit of analysis is a territorial case-month. Buenaventura is modeled as a

municipality-level case because criminal control is concentrated within the city (Insight Crime, 2025). Arauca is modeled at the departmental scale because the relevant armed order extends across the department and is shaped primarily by the Frente Domingo Laín (Insight Crime, 2026). Tumaco is modeled as a regional cluster because armed governance and violence spill across adjacent municipalities (Insight Crime, 2025b). This territorial definition is methodological rather than merely descriptive: it seeks to align the spatial scale of the data with the spatial scale at which armed control and negotiation effects are most likely to operate, and can be further inspected in 1.

Additionally, the design includes a time-varying control for armed-group dispute. The variable *Clash* is coded as a binary indicator equal to 1 in months in which a territorial case is experiencing active inter-group conflict and 0 otherwise. This control is included because changes in violence may reflect not only negotiation dynamics but also shifts in territorial confrontation among armed organizations. In substantive terms, control is especially important for Arauca, where violence rises in the context of an intensifying dispute beginning in January 2022 (Celis, 2026), and for Buenaventura, where the intensity of confrontation changes across periods of conflict and truce (SAGA UNODC, 2024; Reynoso, 2025; RTVC, 2025). Tumaco is coded as exposed to persistent inter-group conflict throughout the observed period. Including this variable helps distinguish the association between peace talks and violence from the association between violence and active armed dispute. More specifically, by adding an interaction term, the model can test whether the association of treatment differs between periods with and without clashes.

The baseline specification with this control is:

$$Violence_{it} = \alpha_i + \lambda_t + \beta Treatment_{it} + \delta Clash_{it} + \theta (Treatment_{it} \times Clash_{it}) + \varepsilon_{it}$$

where $Violence_{it}$ is the monthly count of violent events in territorial unit i and month t , α_i are territorial-case fixed effects, λ_t are month fixed effects, $Treatment_{it}$ equals 1 in months in which peace talks are active in that case, and $Clash_{it}$ equals 1 in months with active armed-group dispute. In this specification, β captures the association between peace talks and monthly violence in case-months without active dispute, conditional on both fixed effects. The coefficient δ captures the association between active armed dispute and violence in non-treatment months, net of negotiations

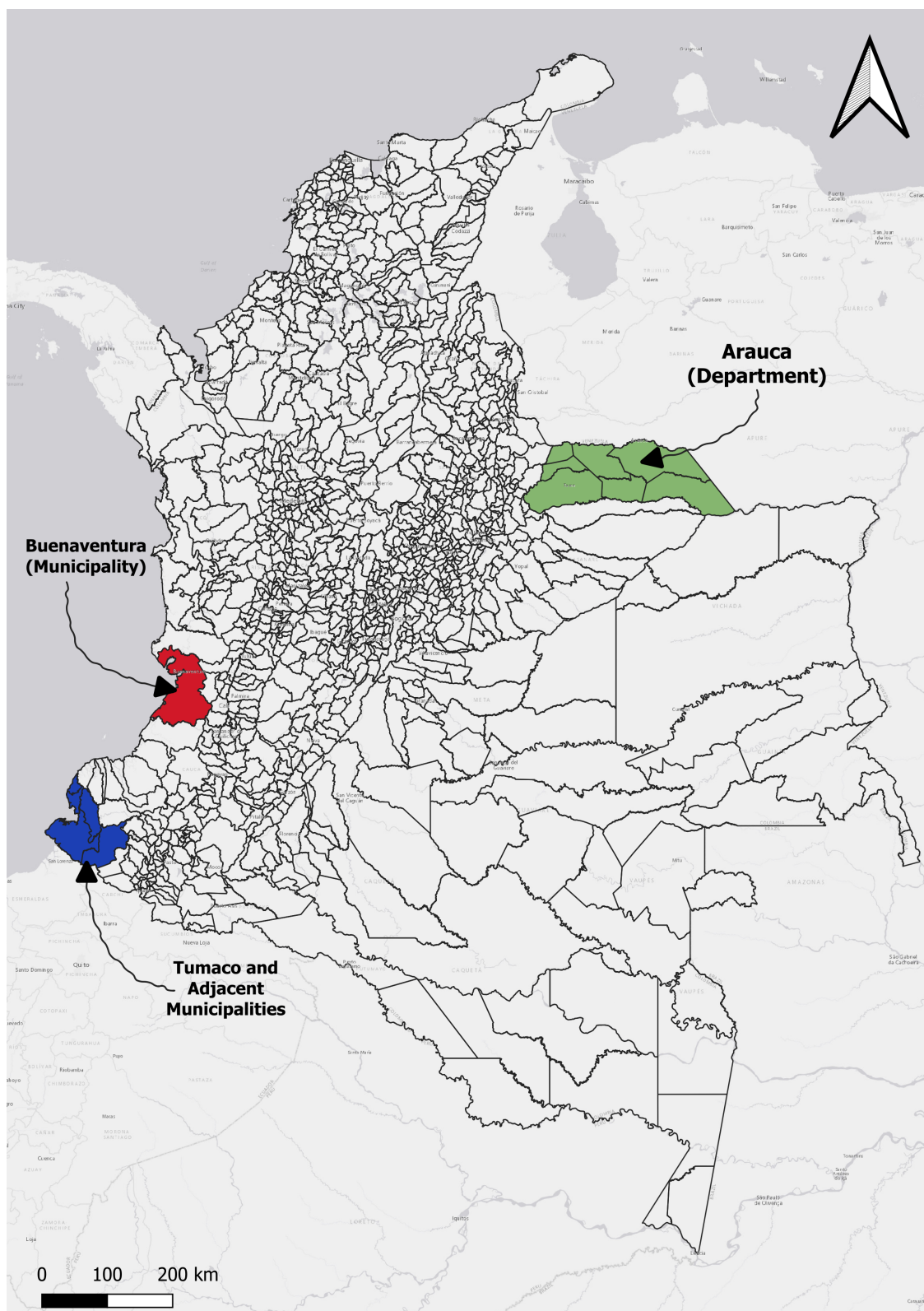


Figure 1: Colombia's map of treatment areas. Made by the Author with ESRI basemap

and fixed effects. The interaction coefficient, θ , captures the additional association when peace talks and active armed dispute occur simultaneously. In substantive terms, the interaction term allows the model to assess whether the association between treatment and violence differs between periods with and without clashes.

This design addresses the main sources of bias that fixed effects are intended to absorb. Armed governance, territorial control, and local institutional capacity are highly persistent over time and are therefore plausibly captured by territorial-case fixed effects. At the same time, common national developments, including changes in the broader implementation of *Paz Total*, military strategy, or macro-political shocks, are absorbed by month fixed effects. The inclusion of the armed-dispute dummy additionally accounts for a substantively important time-varying source of violence that would otherwise risk confounding the treatment effect. As a result, the empirical strategy isolates whether the negotiation period is associated with a deviation from the prior violent trend within each case, net of both enduring territorial characteristics and contemporaneous conflict dynamics. Standard errors are clustered at the territorial-case level, although inference must be interpreted cautiously given the small number of units. The design addresses the causal path as displayed in figure 1.

2.3 Assumptions

The first identifying assumption is that, conditional on territorial-case fixed effects, month fixed effects, and the inclusion of `clash_dummy`, there are no omitted case-specific time-varying shocks that both affect the onset of peace talks and independently alter violence in the same period. This is the key assumption that makes the treatment coefficient interpretable as a within-case association rather than a simple coincidence. It is plausible to the extent that the most important persistent differences across cases are absorbed by α_i , and the most important common shocks are absorbed by λ_t . The inclusion of `clash_dummy` strengthens this design by accounting for months in which active armed-group dispute is likely to affect violence independently of the negotiation process. However, the assumption would still be threatened if, for example, a major local security shock in one case simultaneously triggered negotiations and altered violence through a separate channel that is not fully captured by the observed clash measure.

A second assumption is limited anticipation. Armed actors should not systematically change

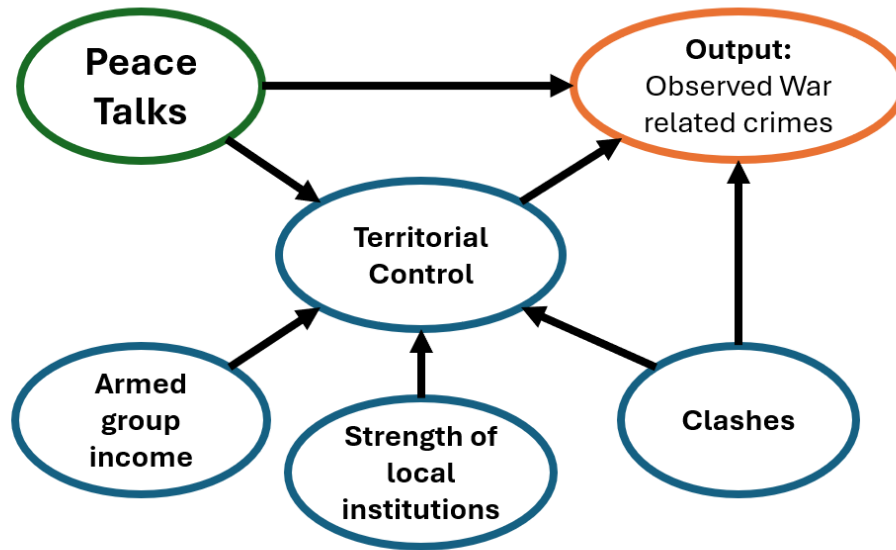


Figure 2: Causal Path: Peace Talks affect the Output (Observed War Related Crimes) and the territorial control. Territorial control affects the violent trends in the region, but mainly depends on the overall strength of the armed group, the civilian resistance and the clashes with other groups. Clashes, are affecting the outcome and the territorial control.

their violent behavior long before the effective onset of peace talks in ways that would already embed the treatment effect in the pre-treatment period. This is addressed by initiating the treatment period once the actors agreed to participate and acted accordingly, rather than when the negotiation table effectively begun.

A third assumption is that spillovers across the three territorial cases are limited enough not to invalidate the within-case comparison. This is addressed in the geographical specification. Moreno's argument is useful here because he shows that armed actors' responses depend on "the level of control that armed actors exert over the territory" (Moreno León, 2017, p. 4). If territorial control and violent responses shift across neighboring areas in direct response to negotiations, part of the observed effect may reflect displacement rather than a pure local treatment effect. Hence the importance of generating a regional cluster depending on the group's presence.

Finally, the specification assumes that the treatment effect is modeled as an average additive shift during peace-talk months. This does not mean that the substantive process is simple. On the contrary, the theoretical framework suggests that negotiations may reduce some forms of violence but shifting to other under-reported ones such as forced disappearance. What the additive

TWFE coefficient captures is the average change in aggregate monthly violence associated with the negotiation period, not the full complexity of all underlying mechanisms. In the same way, the inclusion of `clash_dummy` should not be interpreted as fully modeling the entire strategic structure of armed confrontation. Rather, it controls for one observable dimension of conflict intensity so that the treatment coefficient is less likely to absorb violent changes driven primarily by ongoing armed dispute.

This identification strategy is plausible for three main reasons. First, qualitative evidence suggests that the timing of peace talks was not determined solely by short-run local fluctuations in violence. Johnson et al. (2025) show that the onset of negotiations was shaped by a combination of national political windows, local security crises, and the willingness of armed groups to negotiate. In methodological terms, these sources of variation do not all threaten identification equally. National political windows, such as the launch and prioritization of the *Paz Total* policy, affected all cases and are therefore absorbed by month fixed effects. Local security crises are included in the design through the `clash_dummy`, limited to public information availability. Armed-group willingness to negotiate is more difficult to observe directly, but to the extent that it reflects durable organizational and territorial characteristics, much of it is captured by territorial-case fixed effects. For these reasons, the timing of treatment is unlikely to be systematically driven by unobserved shocks that operate identically across all three cases.

Second, the potential role of armed-group income is compatible with the fixed-effects strategy. Gold and cocaine prices are determined in international markets and cannot plausibly be caused by the onset of peace talks in Buenaventura, Arauca, or Tumaco. In that sense, reverse causality from local negotiations to global prices is not a realistic concern. The more relevant question is whether changes in international prices may affect local violence and, indirectly, the strategic incentives surrounding negotiations. This is theoretically possible. However, because these price series are common to all cases within each month, their confounding role is addressed through month fixed effects in the baseline model.

Third, the fixed-effects design is well suited to the main confounders identified in the literature on Colombian armed conflict. Persistent differences in institutional quality, state presence, territorial control, and local social organization are central to explaining violent variation across territories. Arjona (2016) shows that local institutional strength shapes how armed actors govern and how

communities resist them, while Gutiérrez Sanín and Barón (2006) emphasize the importance of territorial control and armed order in structuring violent dynamics. These are precisely the types of factors that are likely to remain relatively stable within a territorial case over the study period and are therefore absorbed by α_i , the territorial-case fixed effects. Likewise, broader policy changes and common national shocks are absorbed by λ_t , the month fixed effects. In this setting, the empirical strategy therefore isolates whether violence changes within a case once peace talks are underway, net of permanent territorial differences, common monthly shocks, and the observed timing of active armed-group dispute.

At the same time, the design is not free from threats. One possible concern is omitted variable bias from local shocks that coincide with the negotiation period and independently affect violence. This risk is especially relevant in highly localized and fluid urban settings such as Buenaventura, where short-run shifts in gang organization, neighborhood-level competition, or enforcement practices may alter violent trends independently of the talks. The inclusion of `clash_dummy` helps address this concern, but it cannot eliminate it completely because not every local shock takes the form of an observable clash period. Tumaco is permanently exposed to clash as this violent dynamics are constant and under-reported. The risk may be lower in Arauca, where armed governance is more territorially consolidated, but it cannot be ruled out.

For these reasons, the two-way fixed-effects model should not be understood as proving exogeneity, nor as fully eliminating all threats to causal inference. Rather, it makes the identifying assumption more plausible by accounting for the most important sources of confounding highlighted in both the substantive and methodological literature. The resulting estimates should therefore be interpreted as theoretically informed within-case comparisons over time. They provide credible evidence on whether violent trends changed during the period in which peace talks were active, while still requiring caution about local omitted shocks, treatment timing, spillovers, and the very small number of territorial cases.

3 Exploratory Data Analysis

The monthly panel contains 297 territorial case-month observations from January 2018 to March 2026. Across the full sample, the average monthly count of total events is 31.074, with substantial

variation over time and across cases ($sd = 22.735$; $min = 0$; $max = 137$). This already suggests that violence is not distributed evenly across Buenaventura, Arauca, and Tumaco.

Table 1: Table 1: Small descriptive table with treatment timing by case.

Case	mean	sd	min	max	t begin	pre t months	t months
Arauca Department	52.414	21.745	5.000	137.000	2022-10-01	76.000	23.000
Buenaventura	26.182	13.692	0.000	66.000	2023-08-01	70.000	29.000
Tumaco Region	14.626	11.976	0.000	64.000	2024-06-01	78.000	21.000

Table 1 shows these baseline differences more clearly. Arauca has the highest average level of monthly violence, at 52.414 events, and also the highest maximum, at 137. Buenaventura is lower, with an average of 26.182 monthly events, while Tumaco has the lowest mean, at 14.626. Treatment timing also differs across cases. In the current coding, peace talks begin in October 2022 in Arauca, August 2023 in Buenaventura, and June 2024 in Tumaco, corresponding to 23, 29, and 21 treatment months, respectively. These differences matter because the three cases do not enter the negotiation period from the same baseline level of violence.

Table 2: Table 2: Pre-treatment, treatment-period, and clash-status means by case.

Case	pre t	t	diff	no clash	clash	clash diff
Buenaventura	26.957	24.310	-2.647	20.446	37.147	16.701
Arauca Department	50.224	59.652	9.428	49.875	54.804	4.929
Tumaco Region	17.410	4.286	-13.125		14.626	

Table 2 compares pre-treatment, treatment-period, and clash-status means by case. The descriptive pattern is not uniform across territories. Buenaventura shows a small decline in average monthly violence during treatment months, from 26.957 to 24.310, and Tumaco shows a larger decline, from 17.410 to 4.286. Arauca moves in the opposite direction, increasing from 50.224 before treatment to 59.652 during treatment. At the descriptive level, this suggests that peace talks are not associated with one common direction of change across all three cases.

Clash status adds an important qualification. In Buenaventura, average monthly violence is much higher in clash-active months than in clash-inactive months, increasing from 20.446 to 37.147 events. In Arauca, the same comparison is also positive, rising from 49.875 to 54.804. In Tumaco, `clash_dummy` equals 1 in all observed months, so there is no within-case comparison between clash-active and clash-inactive periods. Overall, the descriptive evidence suggests that variation in violence is closely linked to active dispute, and that treatment timing alone should be interpreted

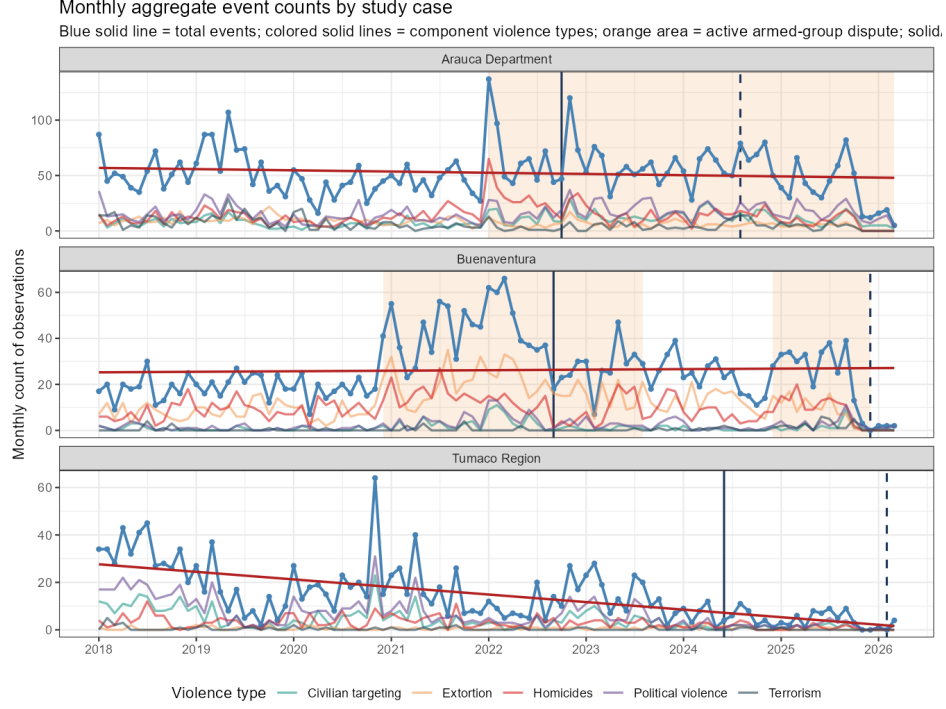


Figure 3: Observations of each type of event across the regions

cautiously before turning to the regression models. Furthermore, by analyzing 3 it can be seen that the trends are different across each territory, and in most cases how the lines move whenever the clashes begin. These differences help address better the impact of the policy across heterogenous cases.

Taken together, the exploratory evidence suggests that the relationship between peace talks and violence is highly context-specific. The descriptive results do not support a single common pattern across the three study areas. Rather, they point to divergent trajectories that should be interpreted in light of different forms of armed governance, territorial control, and active dispute.

4 Results

Across the models, the main question is whether the timing of peace talks is systematically related to aggregate violence and to specific forms of violence. Overall, the results provide only limited support for **H1**. The strongest and most consistent pattern is not the effect of peace talks themselves, but the positive association between active armed-group dispute and higher violence.

Table 3 presents pooled OLS estimates for aggregate violence. In the models without interaction,

Table 3: Pooled OLS: effect of peace talks on aggregate monthly event counts

	(1) Pooled treat. only	(2) + active dispute	(3) + treat.× dispute
Constant	31.53*** (1.52)	33.12*** (2.19)	34.51*** (2.30)
Peace talks active	−1.84 (3.07)	−1.24 (3.12)	−11.01* (6.12)
Active armed-group dispute		−2.81 (2.77)	−5.25* (3.06)
Peace talks × active dispute			13.17* (7.10)
R ²	0.00	0.00	0.02
Adj. R ²	−0.00	−0.00	0.01
Num. obs.	297	297	297

Standard errors in parentheses.

Col. (3): Peace talks, active armed-group dispute, and treat.×dispute.

the treatment coefficient is not statistically significant. In the interaction model, the association between peace talks and violence appears to differ depending on whether clashes are active. The treatment coefficient is negative in non-clash months, while the positive interaction term indicates that this negative association becomes smaller when clashes are active. However, pooled specifications do not account for structural differences across regions, so these results should be treated only as descriptive baseline evidence.

Table 4 introduces case fixed effects, which makes the comparison more appropriate by absorbing time-invariant differences across the three territories. In these models, peace talks are negatively associated with aggregate violence once clash control is included, but this relationship weakens when the interaction is added. At the same time, active armed-group dispute remains large and positive. This suggests that part of the observed change in violence is better explained by whether clashes are taking place than by the onset of negotiations alone.

3.5pt

Then, table 5 provides the preferred aggregate specifications because it includes both case and month fixed effects. In the standard TWFE models, peace talks are not statistically significant, while clash activity remains strongly and consistently associated with more violence. The interaction model shows that the association of peace talks may depend on whether clashes are active,

Table 4: Case fixed effects: effect of peace talks on aggregate monthly event counts

	(1) Case FE treat. only	(2) + active dispute	(3) + treat. × dispute
Peace talks active	−1.92 (2.21)	−5.04** (2.22)	1.28 (4.39)
Active armed-group dispute		12.03*** (2.39)	13.69*** (2.58)
Peace talks × active dispute			−8.50* (5.11)
Num. obs.	297	297	297
Num. groups: case_id	3	3	3
R ² (full model)	0.49	0.53	0.53
R ² (proj model)	0.00	0.08	0.09
Adj. R ² (full model)	0.48	0.52	0.52
Adj. R ² (proj model)	−0.00	0.08	0.08

Standard errors in parentheses.

All columns include territorial-case fixed effects.

Col. (3): Adds peace talks × active armed-group dispute.

but the addition of the interaction coefficient and the treatment coefficient suggests that either way, treatment will have an overall positive effect on violence. In substantive terms, the results are pointing towards an increase in violence whenever the treatment is implemented, however the magnitude is still uncertain, which allows to partially accept H2.

Now, the heterogeneous by-case specification should be interpreted cautiously. Only Buenaventura provides meaningful variation in both treatment status and clash status during the treatment period, which helps explain why only Buenaventura shows a statistically significant case-specific association, while Arauca and Tumaco do not. Further research should analyze cases where there is a clear reporting of clash periods on the region, or use cases with constant clashes such as Tumaco without the interaction term to provide a different perspective within the conflict.

Finally, table 6 breaks the analysis down by type of violence and provides a disaggregated answer. The most notable result appears for *political violence*, where peace talks are positively associated with incidents, but that association becomes weaker when clashes are active, as shown by the negative interaction term. For civilian targeting, homicides, terrorism, and extortion, the treatment coefficients are generally imprecise and not statistically significant at conventional levels.

Table 5: Two-way fixed effects: effect of peace talks on aggregate monthly event counts

	(1) TWFE treat. only	(2) + active dispute	(3) + treat.× dispute	(4) By case + interact.
Peace talks active	4.30 (3.10)	2.91 (2.83)	10.61** (5.28)	
Active armed-group dispute		16.70*** (2.63)	18.78*** (2.88)	22.15*** (3.57)
Peace talks × active dispute			−9.20* (5.33)	
Peace talks (Buenaventura)				11.80** (5.31)
Peace talks (Arauca)				−6.03 (5.07)
Peace talks (Tumaco)				7.73 (5.02)
Peace talks × dispute (Buenaventura)				−5.28 (7.06)
Num. obs.	297	297	297	297
Num. groups: case_id	3	3	3	3
Num. groups: month_id	99	99	99	99
R ² (full model)	0.69	0.75	0.75	0.76
R ² (proj model)	0.01	0.18	0.19	0.21
Adj. R ² (full model)	0.54	0.61	0.62	0.62
Adj. R ² (proj model)	0.00	0.17	0.18	0.19

Standard errors in parentheses.

Cols. (1)–(3): Territorial-case and month fixed effects.

Col. (4): Case-specific peace talks and treat.×dispute.

Arauca/Tumaco interaction terms omitted when collinear; only Buenaventura treat.×dispute reported among interactions.

Table 6: TWFE models by violence outcome (peace talks, active dispute, and interaction)

	Political violence	Civilian targeting	Homicides	Terrorism	Extortion
Peace talks active	4.31** (2.02)	1.87 (1.39)	2.39 (2.21)	-0.24 (1.23)	2.29 (1.87)
Active armed-group dispute	7.43*** (1.10)	6.05*** (0.76)	4.42*** (1.20)	-0.97 (0.67)	1.85* (1.02)
Peace talks $\times$ active dispute	-5.10** (2.04)	-1.43 (1.40)	-0.80 (2.23)	0.56 (1.24)	-2.43 (1.89)
Num. obs.	297	297	297	297	297
Num. groups: case_id	3	3	3	3	3
Num. groups: month_id	99	99	99	99	99
R ² (full model)	0.73	0.70	0.64	0.59	0.67
R ² (proj model)	0.19	0.28	0.09	0.01	0.02
Adj. R ² (full model)	0.58	0.54	0.44	0.37	0.49
Adj. R ² (proj model)	0.18	0.26	0.07	-0.00	0.00

Standard errors in parentheses.

Each column is a separate violence outcome (monthly event counts).

All models include territorial-case and month fixed effects.

This means that **H1** receives only partial support: the timing of negotiations is associated with some forms of violence, especially political violence, but not with a broad or consistent shift across all conflict-related outcomes.

In conclusion, the findings suggest that the relationship between peace negotiations and violence is conditional, outcome-specific, and heavily shaped by the presence of active armed dispute. The most precise model, Two-way fixed effects with interaction term allows to accept partially **H1**, as there is a statistical significance in the 10 percent range that the treatment is increasing the observed violence in the regions. With an active clash, the effect of the treatment is still positive. Which suggests, that aligned with the qualitative findings, the total peace policy could indeed be causally related to an overall increase on violent actions across the implementation regions which allows accepting **H2**.

5 Bibliography

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